

2.6 NABERS COMMITMENT AGREEMENT

Background

NABERS (the National Australian Built Environment Rating System) is a national rating tool which measures the environmental performance of a building, in particular energy and water consumption and waste impact.

A Commitment Agreement is a contract signed by a developer or owner to commit to design, build and commission a building to achieve a specific NABERS energy rating.

Objectives

- To ensure all development will reduce water consumption and can reduce greenhouse gas emissions to net zero
- To encourage the use of rating tools to ensure that the environmental performance of the building is verified at occupancy stage and ensure ongoing improvement over time.

Affects:

- i. office buildings > 1000m² net lettable area
- ii. retail premises > 5000m² gross lettable area
- iii. hotels > 100 rooms
- iv. residential aged care
- v. retirement living
- vi. one of the above plus mixed use

Control

- a) Affected buildings are to sign NABERS Commitment Energy and Water Agreements according to the schedule outlined in Table 1.

Table 1: Minimum NABERS Commitment Agreement requirements

Building type	Required Commitment Agreement
Office buildings > 1000 m ² net lettable area	5.5 Star Energy 4 Star Water
Retail premises > 5000m ² gross lettable area	5.5 Star Energy 4 Star Water
Hotels > 100 rooms	5.5 Star Energy 4 Star Water
Residential Aged Care ²	5 Star Energy 4 Star Water

² Residential Aged Care is a form of seniors housing that falls under the Housing SEPP 2021. It includes residential care facilities in which residents receive full time care, otherwise known as nursing homes or aged care homes.